Digesting Topics by Ved Tripathi

For a science class much like biology, wordiness and memory overload is nothing uncommon. A great teacher must master their own way to convey and break down these topics. My teacher, Mr. Scerra, who teaches 9th grade biology at the Advanced Math and Science Academy, is one of the greatest people I've met at getting complicated ideas across. He is great at breaking down confusing concepts into manageable steps. For example: the steps to cellular respiration, and its correlation to photosynthesis. Mr. Scerra structured this lesson in a way that every step can be understood and how it leads into the next. He prepared hands-on activities for both lessons where we would take paper cut outs of the components in the processes, like glucose and NADP. He walked us through every single step, moving the pieces in chronological order. Instead of one bulk idea, it becomes manageable steps. Each step must be understood to move onto the next, just like how one would advance through levels in a videogame in chronological order. In this way, the complicated steps of cellular respiration and photosynthesis became more than just "how cells extract energy" and "plants create food," but I genuinely understood how glycolysis leads into the Krebs cycle and how cellular respiration goes inverse to photosynthesis. And that is why Mr. Scerra is so good at teaching. He is great at getting ideas across and sparing his students from the wordiness and confusion many people connect to biology. On top of that, he divides up his lessons in a way that students can digest (get the joke?) and makes sure everyone who makes a solid attempt at understanding can move through his series of carefully planned lessons smoothly. I believe that skill is so important in a teacher for any class, especially the sciences. For me, that's the difference between a teacher who just does their job and one who inspires you to think critically.